

Q & A

“Viksit Bharat in reach if female workers increase”

Franziska Ohnsorge, the World Bank’s Chief Economist for South Asia, on trends in female labour force participation rate, policy measures, and more

BY SURABHI ● PHOTO BY HARDIK CHHABRA



16 |

THE WORLD BANK'S
'South Asia Development
Update October 2024:
Women, Jobs and Growth'
said that raising female
labour force participation
rates in the region to those
of men would increase
regional GDP by up to

51%. In an interview with
BUSINESS TODAY, Franziska
Ohnsorge, the World Bank's
Chief Economist for South
Asia, underscores that
this is entirely possible
through societal and eco-
nomic support. Edited
excerpts:

►►►
**The report highlights
the low female labour
force participation rate
(LFPR) in South Asian
countries, partly due to
societal norms. But even
in other East Asian and
African countries, it's**

**largely women who per-
form household chores.
What is the difference
between these regions?**
It is really striking how
low the female LFPR is in
South Asia compared to
the rest of the world. All
South Asian countries